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handmade crochet patterns

No-Sew Christmas Gnome

A plump little gnome worked as ONE continuous piece - body, beard, face and hat all in one tube with simple colour changes and a popcorn nose. Nothing to sew.

Perfect first amigurumi and a fast market-season make.

UK terms

Beginner

1 - 2 hours



FINISHED SIZE

- About 11-12.5 cm (4.5-5 in) tall in worsted / aran on a 3.5 mm hook.
- About 5 cm (2 in) wide at the base.
- One piece - no assembly, no sewing.

Design Code NS X01

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PATTERN OVERVIEW

A plump little gnome worked as ONE continuous piece - body, beard, face and hat all in one tube with simple colour changes and a popcorn nose. Nothing to sew. Perfect first amigurumi and a fast market-season make.

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The nose sits on the round BEFORE the hat-band colour change. Before R14, mark the front of the face (count 14 sts from your round start); the bobble must land centred under the eyes you will place one round above it. Spirals drift to the right as rounds grow - if your front mark has wandered off centre by R14, shift the round start by 1 st so the bobble lands dead centre.

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SAFETY FIRST

If you add safety eyes they are small parts and a choking hazard: lock the washers from the inside BEFORE stuffing and closing, and pull-test. For babies and under-3s, embroider the eyes or leave the face plain - the gnome reads perfectly with just a nose.

Not tested to a toy-safety standard (ASTM F963 / EN 71). Stuff firmly, weave every end in at least 5 cm, and do not market finished gnomes as baby-safe.

MATERIALS

- Body + hat yarn: worsted / aran (#4), 40-50 g, red or green.
- Beard yarn: worsted or fluffy white, 10-15 g.
- Face yarn: skin tone, about 10 g.
- Optional: dark yarn for embroidered eyes, or 2 x 6-8 mm safety eyes.
- Hook: 3.5 mm (US E-4) - or whatever size makes a dense, no-see-through fabric.
- Stuffing: fibre fill about 20-30 g.
- Notions: stitch marker, tapestry needle, scissors.

GAUGE

Gauge is not critical - aim for a firm fabric (about 10-11 dc x 11 rounds = 5 cm). If stuffing shows through, go down half a millimetre.

ABBREVIATIONS

MR magic ring

ch chain

sl st slip stitch

tr double crochet

dtr treble crochet

inc increase (2 tr in one st)

dc2tog double crochet 2 together (decrease; swap for an invisible)

BO 5-dtr bobble (counts as 1 st)

FO fasten off

st(s) stitch(es)

R round

(n) stitch count at round end

CONSTRUCTION & TECHNIQUES

Worked in continuous rounds (do not join, do not chain 1 between rounds) from the base up: body colour, then white beard, then skin-tone face, then the hat in the body colour. Mark the first stitch of every round and move the marker up. Change colours on the final pull-through of the last stitch of the old colour.

1. The magic ring

Wrap yarn around two fingers, insert the hook, pull up a loop and work the first round into the ring; pull the tail tight once the round is complete.

2. Working in a spiral

No joins and no starting chains - keep going round after round. The colour-change lines will slant very slightly; that is the no-sew look.

3. The 5-tr bobble

Yarn over, insert hook in the stitch, pull up a loop, yarn over and pull through 2 loops (incomplete tr). Repeat 4 more times in the same stitch (6 loops on hook). Yarn over and pull through all 6 loops. One bobble counts as ONE stitch and pops the nose.

4. dc2tog decrease

Insert hook, pull up a loop; insert in the next stitch, pull up a loop (3 loops on hook). Yarn over and pull through all 3. On the visible hat rounds (R17-R23) you may prefer the invisible decrease (invdec): insert hook under the FRONT loop only of the next two stitches, yarn over, pull through both front loops, yarn over, pull through 2 loops. Same counts, no bump.

5. Clean colour changes

Work the last stitch of the old colour until 2 loops remain, then pull the new colour through. Give both yarns a gentle tug to keep the join tight.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Body, beard, face & hat - one piece

Start in the body colour (red or green). The R15-16 line, where you switch back to the body colour, forms the hat edge - no folding, no sewing.

Body - body colour

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 dc in MR	(6)	-
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	[dc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
R4	[2 dc, inc] x 6	(24)	-
R5	[3 dc, inc] x 6	(30)	-
R6-8	dc in each st around (3 rnd)	(30)	-

Beard - white (R9-12)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R9-12	dc in each st around (4 rnd)	(30)	-

Face & nose - skin tone (R13-15)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R13	dc in each st around	(30)	-
R14	dc in next 14, BO in next st (nose), dc in remaining 15	(30)	bobble = nose
R15	dc in each st around	(30)	-

Hat - body colour (R16-23)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R16	dc in each st around	(30)	hat edge forms here
R17	[3 dc, dc2tog] x 6	(24)	-
R18	dc in each st around	(24)	-
R19	[2 dc, dc2tog] x 6	(18)	start stuffing
R20	dc in each st around	(18)	-
R21	[dc, dc2tog] x 6	(12)	-
R22	dc in each st around	(12)	top up stuffing
R23	dc2tog x 6	(6)	close

Finish: stuff firmly, adding more before the opening closes. FO with a 15 cm tail, thread through the front loops of the last 6 stitches, pull closed and weave in.

Stuffing shape: pack the base flat and wide so the gnome stands; keep the hat soft so it flops a little.



On the hook - what your rounds should look like as they grow

FINISHING & ASSEMBLY

- Hat brim (optional): join white yarn at the R15-16 colour-change line and work sl st around. FO and weave in - it covers the change line neatly.
- Eyes (optional): 2 embroidered straight stitches or 6-8 mm safety eyes, 1-3 stitches apart, one round above the nose. Lock safety-eye washers BEFORE stuffing and closing the hat tip.
- Extra beard texture: a few surface sl sts or short tied strands of white over R9-12.
- Hanging ornament: ch 18 at the hat tip and sl st into the same place to form a loop. FO and weave in.

TROUBLESHOOTING

- **Colour lines slant noticeably.**

That is the spiral's true line - put the slant at the back. Or join each colour with a sl st and ch 1 for perfectly level stripes, at the cost of a visible seam.

- **The nose bobble will not pop.**

Work the 5 tr loosely and push the bobble toward you as you complete it; finish the round, then nudge it out from the inside while stuffing.

- **Gnome tips over.**

Pack more stuffing into the base and flatten the bottom; the base disc should be noticeably firmer than the hat.

COLORWAYS



Santa red



Forest green



Nordic grey



Candy pink



Midnight navy

HELPFUL TIPS

Size variations

Mini ornament: DK yarn + 3 mm hook. Work R1-R21 (12 sts), stuff firmly, SKIP R22 and work R23: dc2tog around (6), then close as usual - about 8-9 cm tall.

Large decoration: chunky yarn + 5 mm hook. Work R6-8 twice (6 straight body rounds instead of 3) before starting the beard at R9 - about 15 cm tall. Stitch counts are unchanged.

- Why dc2tog here: on a one-piece gnome, neatness matters less than grip - dc2tog pulls the fabric firm against the stuffing. Your needle inside the hat tip is impossible to poke with an invisible decrease, so the classic decrease is deliberate.

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Safety reminder

This pattern has not been tested to a toy-safety standard (ASTM F963 / EN 71). If you use safety eyes, lock the washers before stuffing and closing; for young children, embroider the face or leave it plain.

Happy crocheting!

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